

Objective:

1. **Improving Communication:** Helps ensure everyone in the meeting can communicate effectively and understand each other.
2. **Build Trust:** When meetings are conducted respectfully, it builds trust between participants and can lead to more productive and successful outcomes.
3. **Increase Efficiency:** Creating and following clear agendas and expectations, reducing the time spent on unnecessary discussions.

Business Meeting Etiquette Rules:

Following rules applies for online and offline meetings:

1. Prepare for the meeting:

a. Check the calendar:

- i. Every time you send an invitation or accept an invitation, double-check the calendar and block the time, leaving a buffer of at least 15 minutes before and after the meeting.
- ii. In case you're hosting the meeting, choosing the best time that works for everyone can be challenging, especially if you have participants from different time zones or conflicting schedules.
- iii. Consider everyone's schedule: Ask participants to provide their availability and look for commonly available times.
- iv. Meeting invitations should be sent a minimum of one working day prior to the meeting.

b. Define or understand the purpose of the meeting:

Knowing the purpose of the meeting helps you understand what decisions need to be made and what information needs to be discussed.

c. Invite relevant participants:

- i. **Relevant stakeholders:** Invite people with a vested interest in the outcome of the meeting and can provide valuable input or make decisions.
- ii. **Decision-makers:** If decisions need to be made, only invite those with authority.

- iii. **Key contributors:** If the meeting requires specific expertise or knowledge, invite people who can contribute to those areas.
- iv. **Optional attendees:** If there are people who may not be directly involved in the meeting but could benefit from being in the loop, consider inviting them as well.

d. **Define and follow meeting agenda (F-P-QD-06-01):**

- i. Setting a clear agenda helps keep the meeting focused and on track, reducing the risk of going off-topic and wasting time on unrelated discussions.
- ii. It ensures that everyone knows what will be discussed and what is expected of them, leading to increased clarity and a better understanding of the goals of the meeting.
- iii. If you're the host, send the agenda at least 24 hours prior along with the meeting invitation. It also gives the invitees an easy way out if the meeting topic isn't of their concern.

e. **Test your technology setup, surroundings, and equipment before the meeting:**

Technical issues during a meeting can be disruptive and make you appear unprofessional. Avoid this by testing ahead of time.

Here's a checklist you can keep ensuring everything is in order before going into a meeting:

- i. **Technology setup:** Check your computer, camera, microphone, and internet connection to ensure they are working properly.
- ii. **Surroundings:** Your background or the meeting room should be less distracting and neat. If it's a video conference, make sure the lighting is appropriate.
- iii. **Equipment:** Make sure that you have all the necessary equipment (pen, paper, chargers, etc.) and any relevant documents handy.
- iv. **Agenda and materials:** Review the meeting agenda and other materials you need to present or discuss.
- v. **Time:** Check the time zone difference, if any, and ensure you have the correct time for the meeting.
- vi. **Preparation:** Review any notes or preparations you have made, and ensure you are ready to engage in the meeting.

2. Rules to follow during the meeting:

a. **Be on time:**

- i. **Punctuality:** It shows you are organized, responsible, and respectful of time, which can help make a good impression on others. Please check RME's Competency Framework.
- ii. Arriving late at a meeting can disrupt the flow and show a lack of respect for the attendees and their time.

b. **Turn off mode electronic devices or put on silent mode:**

- i. Ringing phones, buzzing notifications, and other sounds from electronic devices can disrupt the flow of the meeting and distract others. Turn them off or put on silent mode to prevent such disruptions.

c. **Be an active listener:**

- i. Being an active listener can ensure effective communication that can help make more informed decisions, identify and resolve misunderstandings and improve collaboration.
- ii. Pay attention and engage in the meeting rather than multitasking or thinking about other things.

d. **Be respectful:**

- i. Make sure you create a respectful and productive environment for the meeting. A respectful environment can lead to more open and effective communication, as participants feel comfortable sharing their opinions and ideas.
- ii. Open your camera (applies for online meetings).
- iii. **Be courteous:** Use polite language, avoid negative or critical comments, and avoid engaging in behavior that can be perceived as disruptive or disrespectful.
- iv. **Be open-minded:** Consider others' opinions and be open to different perspectives. Avoid being defensive or closed-minded, give constructive feedback.
- v. **Be professional:** Maintain a professional demeanor and avoid using informal language or discussing inappropriate or sensitive topics.
- vi. **Mute and unmute on time:** Keep yourself mute when others talk. This helps to prevent distractions and ensures that the focus is completely on the speaker or presenter.
- vii. **Listen actively:** Be attentive to what others say and avoid interruptions. Ask clarifying questions and make an effort to understand others' perspectives.

- e. **Follow the agenda (F-P-QD-06-01):**
 - i. A well-structured agenda can help ensure the meeting is productive and achieves its goals and objectives. But having an agenda itself isn't enough. You need to follow it diligently. So that you can make sure all relevant topics are covered in a systematic and organized manner, reducing the time required for the meeting and increasing its efficiency.
- f. **Respect confidentiality:**
 - i. Document the meeting: Consider documenting the meeting (F-P-QD-06-02) in a way that protects the confidentiality of the information discussed.
- g. **Send minutes of meeting (F-P-QD-06-02):**
Responsibilities of the meeting initiator:
 - i. Within a reasonable time (24h) after the meeting, send a follow-up email with the minutes of the meeting to all participants, summarizing the main points discussed and decisions made.
 - ii. Record the attendance of each participant (F-PQP-01-15) (when each participant joined the meeting).
- h. **Execute Meeting Decisions:**
 - i. If decisions were made during the meeting, be sure to act on them on time. Follow up on any tasks or assignments that were agreed upon, and keep participants informed of progress.
- i. **Close the loop and archive relevant materials:**
 - i. If any issues or questions are resolved during the meeting, close the loop by following up with the relevant parties. Archive the materials shared during the meeting for future reference.
- j. **How to handle received meeting invitations:**
 - i. Respond by (Accept, Tentative or Decline) within a reasonable time (same day or the following day).
 - ii. If you are unable to attend, consider delegating to another colleague who is capable to handle.

k. Attending External Meetings:

- i. Show up on time
- ii. Always remember you are representing Rowad.
- iii. Follow the recommended business attire (Refer to Head Office Dress Code Policy (M-HR-06)).
- iv. Make sure you have enough business cards
- v. If needed, make your introduction about Rowad precise and positive.